

The Edge of the World - Section 2 Vocabulary

The Witcher: The Last Wish by Andrzej Sapkowski Reading date: August 23, 2026

1. Dandelion at the Feast

Context: ...to the obvious regret of Dandelion, who had been grinning at them ever since the feast began and making them giggle at his gross jokes.

翻译：这显然让丹德里恩很失望；宴会一开始，他就一直冲她们嬉皮笑脸，还讲粗俗的笑话逗得她们咯咯直笑。

- to someone's regret：令某人遗憾或失望的是。
- grin at someone：冲某人咧嘴笑；这里带有调情、献殷勤的感觉。
- ever since...：从.....开始一直到现在或当时。
- make someone giggle：把某人逗得咯咯笑。
- gross jokes：粗俗或下流的笑话；可译为“荤段子”。
- had been grinning：过去完成进行时，强调动作在过去某时之前已经持续了一段时间。

2. A Fallow Field

Context: The field lay fallow.

翻译：那块田处于休耕状态。

- fallow：休耕的，暂时不播种以恢复土壤肥力。
- lie + adjective：处于某种状态；这里 lay 是 lie 的过去式。
- 现代说法：The farmers left the field fallow. / The field was left uncultivated.

3. The Cat by the Hearth

Context: Dandelion cackled again, then flicked a beer-drenched fly at a cat sleeping by the hearth. The cat opened one eye and glanced at the bard reproachfully.

翻译：丹德里恩又嘎嘎大笑起来，随后把一只浑身沾满啤酒的苍蝇弹向睡在壁炉边的猫。猫睁开一只眼，责怪似的瞥了吟游诗人一眼。

- cackle：尖锐、响亮地嘎嘎大笑；比 chuckle 更响、更刺耳。
- flick A at B：用手指把 A 弹向 B。
- beer-drenched：被啤酒浸透或沾满啤酒的。
- hearth：壁炉前的地面、炉边；也可文学性地象征家庭。
- bard：吟游诗人，这里指 Dandelion。
- glance at...：瞥.....一眼。
- reproachfully：责怪地、不满地。
- sleeping by the hearth：现在分词短语，修饰 cat。

4. Mischief and Rascals

Context: He doesn't bother us. He is simply up to mischief.

翻译：他不会烦扰我们，只不过是调皮捣蛋。

Context: The rascal senses the aura and knows he is safe here.

翻译：那个捣蛋鬼感知到了这里的气息，知道自己在这里很安全。

- mischievous：调皮捣蛋、爱恶作剧的。
- mischief：淘气行为或不太严重的恶作剧。
- be up to mischief：正在调皮捣蛋、搞恶作剧。
- bother someone：打扰或烦扰某人。
- rascal：淘气鬼、捣蛋鬼；语气也可以更重，表示无赖。
- sense：察觉、感知到。
- aura：人或地方散发的气息、氛围；奇幻语境中可指魔法气息。
- knows (that) he is safe：that 可以省略。

5. Muffling Laughter

Context: Dandelion turned to the window, muffling his laughter.

翻译：丹德里恩转向窗户，压低笑声，不让别人发现他在笑。

- muffle a sound：压低或遮住声音。
- muffle one's laughter：压低、掩住笑声。
- muffling his laughter：现在分词短语，表示与 turned 同时发生的动作。
- stifle a laugh：强忍住笑，不让自己笑出来。
- suppress a laugh：抑制笑意，较正式。

6. Dwelling in the Hemp

Context: At day he dwells somewhere in the hemp.

翻译：白天，他住在或藏在麻田里的某个地方。

- dwell：居住、栖息，较古老或文学化；现代通常用 live。
- hemp：麻类植物；这里指用于纤维、绳索或布料的麻田。
- somewhere in...：在.....里的某处。
- 表示“白天”时，现代英语更常用 during the day 或 by day。
- 现代说法：By day, he hides somewhere in the hemp field.

7. Bed, Board, and Lodging

Context: Knowing you a little as I do, I take it you haven't abased yourself so as to get us bed, board, and lodging, have you?

翻译：凭我对你的一点了解，我猜你不会为了给我们弄到食宿而低声下气吧？

- Knowing you as I do...：以我对你的了解.....。
- I take it (that)...：我想.....、我猜你.....。
- abase yourself：贬低自己、卑躬屈膝、低声下气。
- so as to...：为了.....，相当于 in order to。
- bed, board, and lodging：床铺、膳食和住处，即“食宿”。
- room and board：现代更常见的“食宿”。
- have you?：对 you haven't... 进行确认的反意疑问句。
- 现代说法：You didn't stoop to asking someone for room and board, did you?

8. An Irresistible Temptation

Context: I could never resist the temptation of having a look at something that doesn't exist.

翻译：我绝对抵挡不住亲眼看看某种不存在之物的诱惑。

- resist the temptation：抵抗诱惑、忍住不做某事。
- have a look at...：看一看.....，偏英式口语。
- something that doesn't exist：某种不存在的东西。
- resist + noun/gerund：resist the temptation / resist looking，不用 resist to look。
- the temptation of doing... 正确；现代英语更常用 the temptation to do....
- 句子的幽默来自悖论：不存在的东西本来不可能被看到。
- 现代说法：I can't resist taking a look at something that supposedly doesn't exist.

9. Stop Wittering

Context: Stop wittering.

翻译：别唠叨了。/ 别没完没了地说了。

- witter：不停谈论无聊或不重要的事情，英式口语，带有不耐烦的语气。
- witter on about...：没完没了地唠叨.....。
- up to no good：准没在干好事；不要与 witter 混淆。

10. A Dense Thicket

Context: Do we have to squeeze through the very middle of this thicket?

翻译：我们非得从这片茂密灌木丛的正中央挤过去吗？

- Do we have to...? : 我们非得……吗？常带有不情愿或抱怨。
- squeeze through... : 从狭窄、拥挤或茂密的地方挤过去。
- the very middle : 正中央；这里 very 表示“恰恰、正是”。
- thicket : 茂密到难以穿过的灌木丛或小树丛。
- 现代说法：Do we really have to go right through the middle of this thicket?

Bushes and Woods

Word	中文	Distinction
bush	灌木、一丛灌木	最常用，较矮且枝叶茂密
shrub	灌木	较正式，常用于园艺或植物分类
hedge	树篱	人工种成一排，用于分隔土地
thicket	茂密灌木丛	密到很难穿过
undergrowth	林下灌木和杂草	生长在树林底层
brush	野外灌木杂草	美式英语常用
scrub	低矮灌木地	常见于干旱、贫瘠地区
grove	小树林	树木不多，通常较整齐、开阔
clump of trees	一簇树	最直白、通用
copse	小树林	较书面，英式英语常见
woods	树林	比 forest 小，日常常用
forest	森林	面积较大的树林
jungle	热带丛林	植被极其茂密的热带森林

11. Fanning and Wiping Sweat

Context: He took off his hat, fanned himself with it, and wiped his sweaty brow.

翻译：他摘下帽子，用帽子给自己扇风，又擦了擦满是汗水的额头。

- take off one's hat : 摘下帽子。
- fan oneself with... : 用……给自己扇风。
- wipe one's brow : 擦额头。
- sweaty : 满是汗的；brow : 额头、眉部。
- took off, fanned, and wiped : 三个平行动词，表示连续动作。

12. Sticky with Honey and Birch Tar

Context: Everything is sticky with honey and birch tar.

翻译：所有东西都沾满了蜂蜜和桦木焦油，黏糊糊的。

- 正确拼写是 sticky，不是 ticky。
- be sticky with... : 因为沾有某物而发黏。
- birch : 桦树；tar : 焦油；birch tar : 桦木焦油。
- 类似结构：His face was wet with rain. / His hands were sticky with jam.

Quick Review

Expression	Meaning
to someone's regret	令某人遗憾或失望的是
make someone giggle	把某人逗得咯咯笑
lie fallow	处于休耕状态
flick A at B	把 A 弹向 B
glance reproachfully	责怪似的瞥一眼
be up to mischief	正在调皮捣蛋
muffle one's laughter	压低或掩住笑声
I take it...	我猜.....
abase oneself	卑躬屈膝、贬低自己
room and board	食宿
resist the temptation to...	抵挡做.....的诱惑
witter on about...	没完没了地唠叨.....
squeeze through...	从.....挤过去
fan oneself with...	用.....给自己扇风
be sticky with...	因沾有.....而发黏